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An Introduction to Islamic Vision of Life

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Objectives of the lecture

- To recognize the concept of meaningful life
- To understand the purpose of life
- To know the Islamic vision of life
- To learn the concept of *Tawhid* and its impacts on human life
- To know about the complete way of life from Islamic perspective (i.e., *din*, *nizam-e-hayat*.)



Basic questions about life

There are some important questions about life

- ❖ What is Life and meaningful life?
- ❖ Why am I here ?
- ❖ What is the purpose of my life ?





What is Life...?

Worldly life is temporary and Hereafter that is the home that will remain forever.

اعْلَمُوا أَنَّمَا الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا لَعِبٌ وَلَهُوَ زِينَةٌ وَتَفَاخُرٌ بَيْنَكُمْ وَتَكَاثُرٌ فِي الْأَمْوَالِ وَالْأَوْلَادِ كَمَثَلِ غَيْثٍ أَعْجَبَ الْكُفَّارَ نَبَاتُهُ ثُمَّ يَهِيجُ فَتَرَاهُ مُصْفَرًّا ثُمَّ يَكُونُ حُطَامًا وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ عَذَابٌ شَدِيدٌ وَمَغْفِرَةٌ مِنَ اللَّهِ وَرِضْوَانٌ وَمَا الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا إِلَّا مَتَاعُ الْغُرُورِ

Know well that the worldly life is but a play and an amusement, and a show of beauty, and exchange of boastful claims between you, and a competition of increase in riches and children. (All this is) like a rain, the growth of which attracts the farmers, then it withers, and you see it turning yellow, then it becomes straw. And in the Hereafter, there is a severe punishment (for the disbelievers), and forgiveness from Allah and (Allah's) pleasure (for the believers and the righteous). The worldly life is nothing but a material of delusion.

(*Surah al Hadeed 57:20*)



Meaningful life

Meaningful life is to obey Allah Almighty and living a life that is linked to an eternal life on one hand and achieving existential meaning from worldly goals and ethical virtues on the other.

وَمِنْهُمْ مَنْ يَقُولُ رَبَّنَا آتِنَا فِي الدُّنْيَا حَسَنَةً وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ حَسَنَةً وَقِنَا عَذَابَ النَّارِ

And there are men who say: "Our Lord! Give us good in this world and good in the Hereafter and defend us from the torment of the Fire!"

(*Surah al Baqara 2:201*)



Why I am here?

الَّذِي خَلَقَ الْمَوْتَ وَالْحَيَاةَ لِيَبْلُوَكُمْ أَيُّكُمْ أَحْسَنُ عَمَلًا وَهُوَ الْعَزِيزُ الْغَفُورُ

He Who created Death and Life, that He may try which of you is best indeed: and He is the Exalted in Might

(*Surah al Mulk 67:2*)



Purpose of life in Islam

Life is highly and significantly purposeful, The purpose of creation for all humankind to recognize Allah Almighty and worship Him.

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالْإِنْسَ إِلَّا لِيَعْبُدُونِ

“And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me”

(*Surah al Tur 51:56*)



Purpose of life in Islam

UBUDIYYAH Allah's Obedience & Servitude out of His Love & Reverence

(The Islamic Vision of Life, Vol. II, Page: 226. By Khurshid Ahmad)



Ubudiyyah



Islam

Submission to Allah



Muslim

**One who
Submits to
Allah**



Deen

**Total System of
Submission to Allah**



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DEEN

Operational Application of

‘UBUDIYYAH



Islamic vision of life:

Human being is a viceroy, servant and trustee

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلٰٓئِكَةِ اِنِّىْ جَاعِلٌ فِى الْاَرْضِ خَلِیْفَةً

when your Lord said to the angels: “Lo! I am about to place a vicegerent on earth,

(Surah al Baqarah 2:30)

(The Islamic Vision of Life, Vol. II, Page: 7-18. By Khurshid Ahmad)



Well-wishing

عَنْ تَمِيمِ الدَّارِيِّ أَنَّ النَّبِيَّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ الدِّينُ النَّصِيحَةُ قُلْنَا لِمَنْ قَالَ لِلَّهِ وَلِكِتَابِهِ وَلِرَسُولِهِ وَلِأَئِمَّةِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَعَامَّتِهِمْ

"Tamim al-Dari reported the Prophet (May peace be upon him) as saying; Religion conduct; religion consists in sincere conduct. The people asked; to whom should it be directed, Messenger of Allah? He replied :To Allah, his book, his Apostle, the leaders (public authorities) of the believers and all the believers, and the leaders (public authorities) of Muslim and the Muslims and the Muslims in general"

(Sunan Abi Dawud Book 43, Hadith 172)



Benefits for all

وَحَيْرُ النَّاسِ أَنْفَعُهُمُ لِلنَّاسِ

“The Holy Prophet ﷺ says: The best person is the one who benefits all human beings”

(*Al Muajam ul Ausat, Al-Tabarani, Hadith No. 5787*)



Unity in Life (*Tawhid*) and its impact

Muslim is required to submit himself completely to the will of Allah in all his affairs.

(For details see: (The Islamic Vision of Life, Vol. II, Page: 7-18. By Khurshid Ahmad)

قُلْ إِنَّ صَلَاتِي وَنُسُكِي وَمَحْيَايَ وَمَمَاتِي لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

“Say, :My prayer, my offering, my life and my death are for Allah, the Lord of all the worlds.”

(*Surah al Ana'am* 6:165)

(The Islamic Vision of Life, Vol. II, Page: 27. By Khurshid Ahmad)



Tawhid's impact on Governance

إِنَّ الْحُكْمَ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ أَمَرَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ ذَلِكَ الدِّينُ الْقَيِّمُ

“All sovereignty (*hukm*) belongs to Allah, He has commanded that you serve non but Him, This is the Right Way of Life (*dhalika al-din al-qayyim*)”

(*Yusuf 12:40*)



Tawhid's impact on Financial matters

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَأْكُلُوا أَمْوَالَكُم بَيْنَكُم بِالْبَاطِلِ إِلَّا أَنْ تَكُونَ تِجَارَةً عَنْ تَرَاضٍ مِنْكُمْ

“Those who believers don’t eat up your property, among yourselves in vanities: But let them be amongst your trading by mutual good will”

(*an-Nisa 4:29*)



Tawhid's impact on administrative justice

إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُ بِالْعَدْلِ وَالْإِحْسَانِ وَإِيتَاءِ ذِي الْقُرْبَىٰ وَيَنْهَىٰ عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ وَالْبَغْيِ يَعِظُكُم
لَعَلَّكُمْ تَذَكَّرُونَ

“Surely Allah enjoins justice, kindness, and doing of good to kith and kin and forbids all that is shameful, evil and oppressive”

(*Al-Nahal* 16:90)



Tawhid's translation in Law

وَالسَّارِقُ وَالسَّارِقَةُ فَاقْطَعُوا أَيْدِيَهُمَا جَزَاءً بِمَا كَسَبَا نَكَالًا مِنَ اللَّهِ وَاللَّهُ عَزِيزٌ حَكِيمٌ

“As for a man or a woman who commits theft, cut off the hands of both to punish them for what they earned, a deterrent punishment from Allah. Allah is Mighty, Wise”

(al- Maidah 4:38)

الزَّانِيَةُ وَالزَّانِي فَاجْلِدُوا كُلَّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهُمَا مِائَةَ جَلْدَةٍ وَلَا تَأْخُذْكُمْ بِهِمَا رَأْفَةٌ فِي دِينِ اللَّهِ

“Those who fornicate whether female or male, flog each one of them a hundred lashes. And let not tenderness for them deter you from what pertains to Allah’s din”

(al-Noor 24:2)



Islam: A complete way of life

- Islam provides specific guidelines for all people to follow in their daily lives.
- Its guidance is comprehensive and includes the social, economic, political, moral, and spiritual aspects of life.
- Islam is a complete way of life means that it covers all the fields of human life.

(Islam at a Glance, Page: 84. By Sadʿrud dīn Islāhī)



Islam: A complete way of life

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا ادْخُلُوا فِي السِّلْمِ كَافَّةً وَلَا تَتَّبِعُوا خُطُوَاتِ الشَّيْطَانِ إِنَّهُ لَكُمْ عَدُوٌّ مُبِينٌ

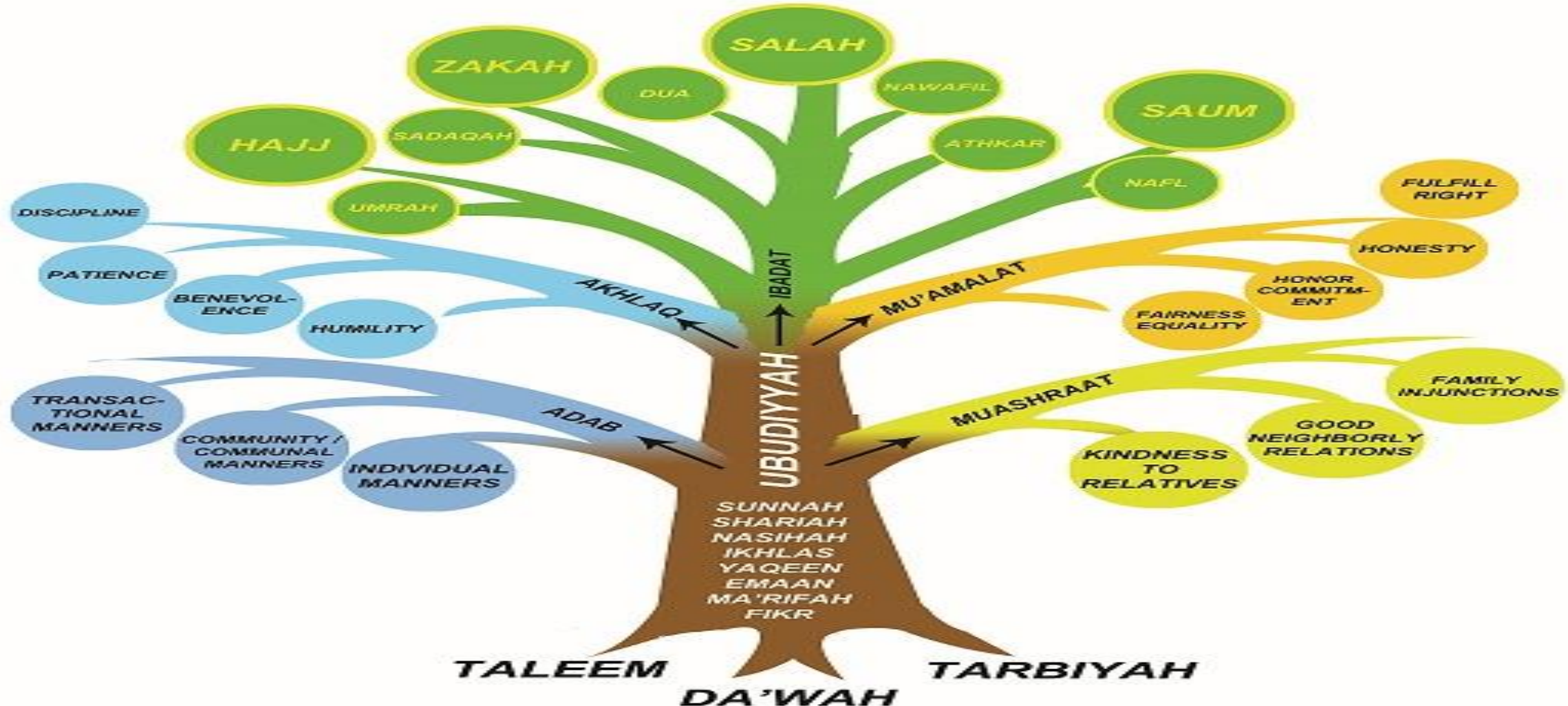
“O ye who believe! Enter into Islam whole-heartedly; and follow not the footsteps of the evil one; for he is to you an avowed enemy”

(*Surah al Baqarah 2:208*)



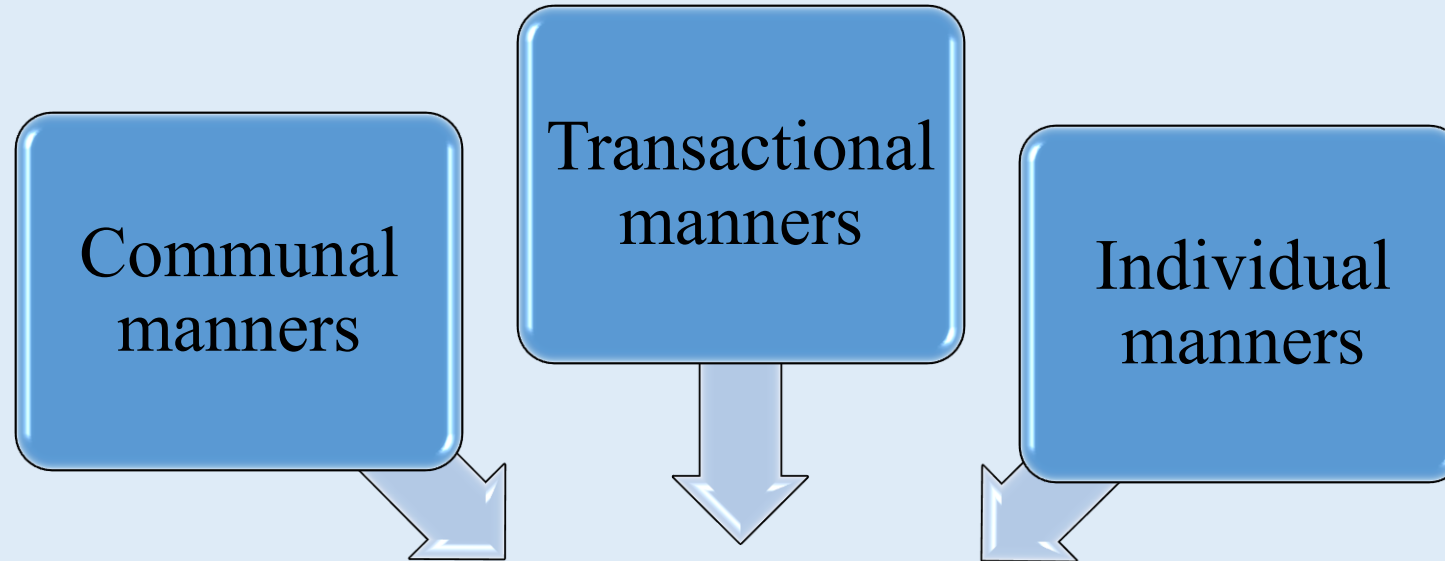
لقد من الله على المؤمنين إذ بعث فيهم رسولاً من أنفسهم يتلو عليهم آياته ويزكيهم ويعلمهم الكتاب والحكمة وإن كانوا من قبل لفي ضلال مبين

Indeed Allah did confer a great favor upon the believers when He sent among them a messenger from among themselves, reciting to them the Revelations of Allah, and purifying them, and teaching them the Scripture and Wisdom, although before that they were in manifest error. Aali 'Imran 164





Manners: *Adab*



يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَقْدَمُوا بَيْنَ يَدَيِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ

O you who believe, do not proceed ahead of
Allah and His Messenger,

(Surah al Hujrat 49:1)



Ethics: *Akhlaq*

Humility

وَعِبَادُ الرَّحْمَنِ الَّذِينَ يَمْشُونَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ هَوْنًا

The servants of the RaHman (the All-Merciful, Allah) are those who walk on the earth humbly

(Surah al Furqan 25:63)

Benevolence

وَالْكَاظِمِينَ الْغَيْظَ وَالْعَافِينَ عَنِ النَّاسِ وَاللَّهُ يُحِبُّ الْمُحْسِنِينَ

And those who control anger and forgive people. And Allah loves those who are good in their deeds,

(Surah al-Imran 3:134)

Patience

وَلَمَنْ صَبَرَ وَغَفَرَ إِنَّ ذَلِكَ لَمِنْ عَزْمِ الْأُمُورِ

And if one observes patience and forgives, it is, of course, one of the courageous conducts.

(Surah al Shura 42:43)

Discipline

إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ كَانَتْ عَلَى الْمُؤْمِنِينَ كِتَابًا مَوْقُوتًا

Surely, Salah is an obligation on the believers that is tied up with time..

(Surah al Nisa 4:103)



Mu'amalat

Fairness
Equality

اعْدِلُوا هُوَ أَقْرَبُ لِلتَّقْوَى

Do justice. That is nearer to Taqwa

(Surah al-Maidah 5:8)

Commitment

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا أَوْفُوا بِالْعُقُودِ

O you who believe, fulfill the contracts

(Surah al-Maidah 5:1)

Honesty

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَكُونُوا مَعَ الصَّادِقِينَ

O you who believe, fear Allah, and be in the company of the truthful.

(Surah al Taubah 9:119)

Fulfill Rights

وَاتِ ذَا الْقُرْبَىٰ حَقَّهُ وَالْمِسْكِينَ وَابْنَ السَّبِيلِ وَلَا تَبْذُرْ تَبْذِيرًا

Give the relative his right, and the needy and the wayfarer. And do not squander recklessly.

(Surah al Asra 17:26)



Muashraat

Kindness to
relatives

عَنْ أَنَسٍ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ " مَنْ سَرَّهُ أَنْ يُبْسَطَ لَهُ فِي رِزْقِهِ وَيُنْسَأَ لَهُ فِي أَثَرِهِ فَلْيَصِلْ رَحِمَهُ "

Anas reported the Messenger of Allah saying : Anyone who is pleased that his sustenance is expanded, and his age extended should do kindness to his near relatives.

(Sunan Abi Dawud 1693)

Good
neighborly
relations

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، عَنِ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ " مَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَلَا يُوْذِ جَارَهُ،

Narrated Abu Huraira: The Prophet said, "Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day, should not hurt his neighbor

(Sahih al-Bukhari 6136)

Family
Injunctions

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا قُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ وَأَهْلِيكُمْ نَارًا

O you who believe, save yourselves and your families from a fire-

(Surah al Tehreem 66:6)



Summary

Islamic concept of life is natural, realistic and highly purposeful as man is viceroy of Allah Almighty. This position demands that he should be obedient to Allah. It establishes a true relationship between man and this world. According to the Islamic concept of life, the world is not a thing to be hated and abandoned, nor a thing to fall in love with to be lost in its luxuries. Islam provides all means and powers necessary for living progressing step by step. *Tawhid* is a revolutionary concept and establishes the essence of the teachings of Islam. It means that there is only one supreme Lord of the universe. Islamic concept of *Tawhid* is the foundation of Islam, which shows the impacts on personal and social life. Islam provides specific guidelines and principles comprehensively for all walks of life.



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